StoryCast

An accessible media microsite for Noble Family Church Rwanda

Research & Documentation · Levis Ishimwe · October 2026

Built with semantic HTML5, Sass (tokens, BEM, cascade layers) and vanilla JavaScript — no frameworks.

1. Project overview

StoryCast presents testimonies, teaching and worship from Noble Family Church Rwanda as audio and video stories. Every story has an accessible player, a transcript and links to related stories. The site has three page types: **Home**, **Story (detail)** and **About & Access**.

Page	File	Purpose
Home	`/index.html`	Introduces StoryCast with a muted background video of the church's Harvest Service, a featured testimony, all seven stories, service times and the "watch, read or listen" options.
Story (detail)	`/story/*.html` (7 pages)	One story per page: embedded media in a `<figure>`, story facts, scripture, key takeaways, transcript, related stories and previous/next links.
About & Access	`/about.html`	Mission, information about the church, accessibility features, how to engage, and an accessibility contact.

2. Research

Audience

- **Church members** who missed a service and want to catch up on a phone, often on mobile

data.

- **Parents and young people** looking for family teaching (prayer for children, marriage, growing in faith).

- **Visitors and the diaspora** who do not speak Kinyarwanda well and need English summaries.

- **People with disabilities**: deaf and hard-of-hearing users (captions, transcripts), blind and low-vision users (screen readers, contrast, zoom), and keyboard-only users.

Content audit

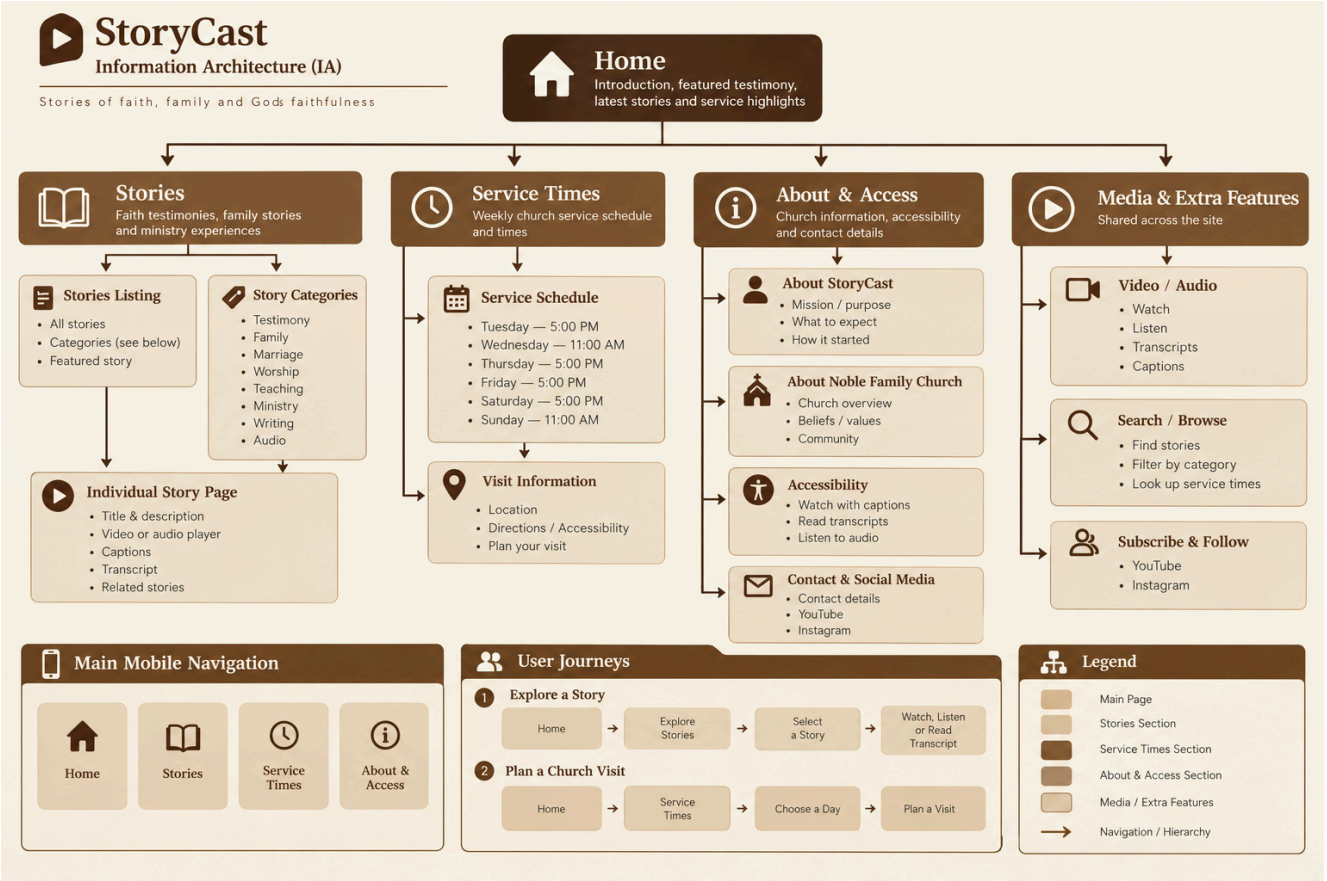
Seven stories were selected from the church's YouTube channel (Women Foundation Ministries) and related channels, plus a local video and a local audio file.

Story	Speaker	Type	Length
Girl, Pray and Grow for Impact	Miss Naomie Nishimwe	YouTube	41:19
Praying Parents, Blessed Children	Apostle Mignonne Kabera & Miss Naomie	YouTube	2:12:43
The Woman in the Tent, the Man at the Gates	Apostle Mignonne Kabera	YouTube (live replay)	—
Worship at the Kagugu Reopening Service	Worship team	YouTube	40:03
The Mercy of God	Pastor Frank Karemera	YouTube	1:08:05
Christ Lives in Me (Nabambanwe na Kristo)	Aime Frank	Local `<video>` + WebVTT captions	13:21
Thank God	Minyone	Local `<audio>`	3:19

Key findings that shaped the design

- Almost all messages are in Kinyarwanda, and YouTube's automatic captions detect the wrong language — so **English transcript summaries** on the page are essential.
- Most visitors arrive on phones: the layout is **mobile-first**, and media keeps a 16:9 frame at every width.
- People want to know **when to come**: service times (Tue–Sun; Wed & Sun 11:00 AM, others 5:00 PM) are on the home page and in every footer.
- An autoplaying background video can distract or cause motion sickness: it starts **muted**, has a **Pause** button, and does not play when the user prefers reduced motion.

3. Information architecture



Sitemap (also in `doc/sitemap.svg`).

Content hierarchy

```
├─ Hero: background video + h1 + "Explore stories" / "Service times"├─ Featured testimony
(spotlight)
├─ #stories — Featured stories (7 cards → /story/*.html)
├─ #services — Service times (Tue–Sun)
```

```
├─ Breadcrumb: Home / Stories / Title
├─ article: h1, facts (dl), figure (media + figcaption)├─ About this story ·
Scripture · Key takeaways
├─ #transcript (show/hide, download .txt)
├─ Previous / Next story
```

```
├─ Mission · Vision · Values
├─ Noble Family Church Rwanda
├─ #access — Accessibility features
└─ How to engage · Contact · Start with these stories
```

```
└─ Watch / Read / Listen → about.html#access
```

```
Story detail (/story/<slug>.html)
```

```
└─ aside: Related stories (3 cards)
```

```
About & Access (about.html)
```

```
Home (index.html)
```

4. Wireframes & high-fidelity mockups

Figma links:

Wireframes:
https://www.figma.com/design/CH95Yk2cGZz1T03carXEfa/wireframe?node-id=2-346&t=BCpsihjnc1TtBUqN-1

High-fidelity mockups:
https://www.figma.com/design/MyjA8xAqW2JW19Nx2NDUHj/stroycast-mockup?node-id=0-1&t=qfxBuAVZEidx2zMx-1

The wireframes follow the hierarchy above. The mockups use the chocolate brown and white design system below.

5. Design system (Sass tokens)

Colour — chocolate brown & white (`sass/tokens/_colors.scss`)

Token	Hex	Use	Contrast
chocolate-900	#3B1F12	Body text, header, footer	15.1 : 1 with white
chocolate-700	#5C3317	Brand, buttons, links	10.8 : 1 with white
chocolate-500	#7B4A2D	Eyebrows, tags	7.3 : 1 with white
muted	#6E5547	Secondary text	6.3 : 1 on cream
caramel-200	#E8C9A6	Text and focus ring on dark	9.6 : 1 on chocolate-900
cream-100 / white	#FAF5EF / #FFFFFF	Page backgrounds	—

Every pair passes WCAG 2.1 AA (4.5 : 1 for text); most pass AAA (7 : 1).

Typography (`_typography.scss`) and spacing (`_spacing.scss`)

Merriweather (headings) and Poppins (body). Sizes use `clamp()` for fluid scaling. Spacing uses a map (`3xs` –`3xl`) and a `space()` function; breakpoints use an `up()` mixin.

6. Sass & CSS architecture

```
sass/
├─ main.scss          ← @use's every partial, in layer order
├─ _layers.scss       ← @layer reset, tokens, base, layout, components, pages, utilities;
├─ tokens/   _colors _typography _spacing _breakpoints
├─ base/     _reset _base
├─ layout/   _grid _header _footer
├─ components/ _buttons _navigation _hero _story-card _media _transcript _schedule
├─ pages/    _home _story _about
└─ utilities/ _accessibility
```

- **Cascade layers:** every partial wraps its rules in its layer, so the layer order — not specificity — decides conflicts.
- **BEM naming:** e.g. `.story-card__title`, `.btn--primary`, `.schedule__item--morning`.
- **Grid + Flexbox:** Grid for page layouts (story grid, story/sidebar layout, footer columns); Flexbox for headers, button groups and media rows.
- **Container query:** each `.story-grid__item` is a named container (`story-card`). The card is compact below 18rem, stacked by default, and horizontal from 32rem — so the same card adapts to the home grid, the story sidebar and the full-width related list on tablets.

7. Accessibility checklist (WCAG 2.1 AA)

✓ **Semantic structure:** `header` , `nav` , `main` , `article` , `section` , `aside` , `figure` / `figcaption` , `footer` , `dl` , `blockquote` / `cite` , `time` . One `h1` per page; headings never skip a level.

✓ **Captions & transcripts (1.2.1, 1.2.2):** local video has a `<track kind="captions">` WebVTT file; YouTube embeds use `cc_load_policy=1` ; every story has a transcript on the page and a downloadable `.txt` in `/assets/transcripts` .

✓ **Contrast (1.4.3, 1.4.11):** all text pairs ≥ 6.3 : 1; focus ring ≥ 3 : 1 on both light and dark areas.

✓ **Keyboard (2.1.1, 2.4.1, 2.4.7):** skip link, logical tab order, no keyboard traps, a visible 3px `:focus-visible` ring everywhere. Whole-card links use one focusable title link (stretched link).

✓ **Pause, stop, hide (2.2.2):** background video has Pause/Play and Sound buttons, starts muted, and stays paused with `prefers-reduced-motion` .

✓ **ARIA where HTML is not enough:** `aria-current` (nav, breadcrumb), `aria-labelledby` on landmarks, `aria-expanded` + `aria-controls` on the transcript toggle, `aria-live` for video state, `aria-describedby` linking players to captions, `aria-hidden` on decorative icons and the background video.

✓ **Images (1.1.1):** meaningful images have descriptive `alt` ; decorative card thumbnails use `alt=""` because the title names the story.

✓ **Links:** links that open a new tab say so to screen readers.

✓ **Reflow & zoom (1.4.4, 1.4.10):** mobile-first layouts in relative units (rem, %, clamp) reflow to a single column on small screens with no horizontal scrolling.

Testing

Test	Result
axe-core 4.10 (WCAG 2.0/2.1 A + AA + best practice) on Home, About and the story pages	0 violations
Keyboard support	Every control is a native link, button or media element (no positive tabindex, no custom widgets); skip link and focus ring present on every page
Responsive check at 390px, 820px and 1366px	No overflow; container query switches card layout
Transcript toggle	`aria-expanded` and label update correctly

8. Running locally

```
npm install -g sass                          # once
sass --watch sass/main.scss css/main.css     # compile Sass
# then open with VS Code Live Server, or:
python -m http.server 5500                   # visit http://localhost:5500
```

Use a local server (not double-clicking the file) so the WebVTT caption track loads.

9. GitHub repo link: https://github.com/rhoda-n1cole/storycast